



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Research Integrity Policy

Document ID: ZSMC-POL-001 Rev 0

Effective Date: 16-08-2026

Evidence before prestige. Reproducibility before publicity. Intellectual contribution before title. Scientific honesty before institutional interest.

This policy establishes the standards of scientific integrity applicable to all research conducted, supported, represented, or published by The ZSMC Co. ("ZSMC").

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that ZSMC research is conducted honestly, transparently, responsibly and in a manner that permits meaningful evaluation and, where reasonably practicable, independent reproduction.

X 

Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Scope

This policy applies to all ZSMC researchers, research advisors, collaborators, contributors, and all other individuals acting on behalf of ZSMC.

It applies to experimental, computational, theoretical, engineering and interdisciplinary research.

X 

Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Fundamental Principles

As per ZSMC-GOV-001 Rev 0, all research conducted under the ZSMC affiliation shall be guided by the following principles:

Honesty - Research shall be represented accurately. ZSMC shall not knowingly fabricate, falsify, manipulate, or selectively misrepresent research findings.

Reproducibility - Where reasonably possible, research shall be documented sufficiently for another competent researcher to understand and reproduce the relevant methodology.

Transparency - Researchers shall distinguish clearly between established findings; experimental observations; modeled or simulated results; hypotheses; assumptions; preliminary results; and future objectives.

Intellectual Humility - Researchers shall acknowledge uncertainty, limitations, failed experiments, contradictory evidence, and alternative explanations where relevant.

Responsible Communication - Public communications shall not deliberately exaggerate the significance, maturity, safety, performance, or certainty of research findings.

Correction - When a material error is discovered in a ZSMC research output, the Organization shall seek to correct the public record appropriately.

X 

Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Prohibited Research Practices

ZSMC prohibits:

- fabrication of data, observations, results, or sources;
- falsification or deliberate manipulation of research data;
- plagiarism or unattributed appropriation of intellectual work;
- deliberate omission of material results for the purpose of misleading the reader;
- selective reporting intended to create a false impression of performance or validity;
- misrepresentation of experimental, computational, or theoretical results;
- knowingly presenting simulations, predictions, or theoretical results as experimental observations;
- knowingly presenting preliminary results as established scientific conclusions;
- unauthorized alteration or destruction of research records;
- misrepresentation of authorship or intellectual contribution;
- knowingly making false claims regarding peer review, publication, funding, affiliation, collaboration, or institutional status.

X 

Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Evidence and Claims

Research claims shall be proportionate to the evidence supporting them.

Where applicable, researchers shall distinguish between:

- theoretical predictions;
- simulations and modeled results;
- preliminary observations;
- experimental measurements;
- independently reproduced results;
- externally validated results; and
- established conclusions.

Uncertainty, anomalous results, failed experiments, and relevant limitations shall not be deliberately concealed when they materially affect interpretation.

X 

Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Research Records

Researchers shall maintain sufficient records to establish, where reasonably practicable:

- what was investigated;
- why it was investigated;
- how the investigation was conducted;
- what data or observations were obtained;
- how those data were analyzed;
- what assumptions were made;
- what conclusions were reached; and
- what limitations or deviations occurred.

Research records shall be maintained in accordance with ZSMC's applicable data, reproducibility, and document-control requirements.

X 

Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Corrections and Retractions

When a material error is identified in a ZSMC research output, ZSMC shall seek to correct the public record in a manner proportionate to the error.

Depending on the circumstances, corrective action may include:

- correction of a webpage or document;
- publication of an amended version;
- publication of a correction notice;
- notification to relevant collaborators or publishers; or
- withdrawal or retraction where necessary.

Corrections shall not be treated as institutional failures in themselves. Maintaining an accurate scientific record takes precedence over preserving appearances.

X 

Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Research Misconduct

Allegations of research misconduct shall be treated seriously and reviewed fairly.

Where an allegation concerns a member of ZSMC, the person accused shall not be the sole decision-maker regarding the allegation.

Where appropriate, ZSMC may seek independent review or advice from an external researcher or qualified institution.

The seriousness of an allegation shall be assessed according to the available evidence rather than the seniority or reputation of the individuals involved.

X 

Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Conflicts Between Institutional Interests and Scientific Integrity

No organizational objective, funding arrangement, partnership, publicity opportunity, award, commercial interest, or reputational consideration shall justify falsification, suppression, or deliberate misrepresentation of scientific evidence.

Where institutional interests conflict with scientific integrity, scientific integrity shall prevail.

X 

Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Responsibilities

All ZSMC researchers are responsible for:

- complying with this policy;
- maintaining accurate research records;
- reporting findings honestly;
- identifying significant errors;
- disclosing relevant conflicts;
- respecting the intellectual contributions of others; and
- raising good-faith concerns regarding research integrity.

Organizational leadership is responsible for maintaining an environment in which researchers can report concerns without retaliation.

X 

Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.



THE
ZSMC CO
ESTD 2026



Review

This policy shall be reviewed when material changes to ZSMC's research activities, organizational structure, or applicable requirements make revision appropriate.

X 

Srijal Dutta
Founder
The ZSMC Co.